

The Anointing of the Believer I

In the last early class, I think we took a good look at the tender lovingkindness and mercies of God through the ages. I had the best time going back to when Noah landed and took of the seven clean beasts, took the one left over, left three couples, and sacrificed that one. I do not know how long it took to sacrifice one of each clean beast. It must have taken quite a while.

Nevertheless, God gathered the whole family of the earth together and gave them instructions on how to walk before Him.

Looking at His tender lovingkindness and mercies, since He visited me in February, I think it has never been more real to me that if you had asked me fifteen or twenty years ago, "What do you want from God?" I would have answered very quickly, "More power. Maybe a couple of cars and a truck. Maybe a truck and a couple of cars."

But since He rolled back one onion-peel-thick layer of Himself and I got to see His heart, maybe taste a little bit of compassion, probably as much as I could bear in my present state, if you asked me now what I want, I would say this: when I was talking about His power, I said, "I want all You have, and I would like to have it yesterday." But now, if you asked me, I would want more of whatever made me feel the way I felt in my spirit.

Of course, it made it to my soul. It made my walk with Him in the Spirit a hundred times more enjoyable. It put a whole new light on testings, trials, and different things that have happened.

I have seen a lot of men who were used on a real good level of miracles break down or be destroyed somewhere along the way, or finish their course with much tribulation, fear, and worry. If you ask me now what I want, I want more of what that was. Just enough of it, just a little visitation of it, took me a month or two to understand that it was the heart of my Father being revealed to me.

He is love, so that manifested in compassion. It also manifested in more and more freedom from tormenting fear. So if you ask me what I want, I want more of that.

When Jesus was talking, He said:

Henceforth I call you not servants... but I have called you friends.

I do not think you can go to slave status without becoming His friend. In the New Testament, He graduates you from servant. He said the great ones among you, your ministers, will be your servants. But he that is chief, he that comes in first, both here and in the kingdom to come, graduates one more step. He becomes your slave.

I do not think you can reach slave status until you become His friend. Jesus said the servant does not know what his master does. The slave really does not know what his master does, but a friend does. He said, "Henceforth I call you friends," because all the Father had shown Him, He had shown unto them.

When Gary broke open that shadow under the law about taking an awl and nailing the servant's ear to the doorpost of the master's house, it was a very interesting set of Scriptures. The Hebrew who had to sell himself to a master was owned by that master and was under law as a slave. Then came the Jubilee, which was Jesus, and the slave to God under the law was set free.

After he was set free, liberated by the Jubilee, born again, he turned back around and said, "By my own free will now, I want to become your slave for the rest of my life." So they nailed his ear to the doorpost of the master's house, and he was his slave forever.

That is what a slave is. You are free, all right, and you love your Lord. You know what He is doing. By your own decision, you nail your ear to God's doorpost. You will serve Him and Him alone. From Him you will take your instructions. Him you will follow. Him you will serve.

I do not think you can go to slave status until you go to friend status, where you know what your Lord does.

That is the main thing I found out about this last place my Father brought me. He started answering some of those age-old questions I had forever in this unveiling of Himself. He began talking to me like a friend.

He said, "Because I am God, I get the blame for many things in this world that I cannot do, because I am God."

He started fellowshiping with me and talking to me on a level He never had in my memory. He would lay a revelation out before, but not talk to me on that level. If you ask me what I want more of, I want more of that kind of fellowship.

One of the age-old questions He started answering was something I have mentioned probably ten times, especially in the early services: Why could people like Mother Teresa and others who dedicated their whole lives not receive more? Why could You not go visit them? Does selling yourself out totally not warrant some kind of visit from You?

That is when He said to me, "What makes you think I did not?"

But He can only visit her the same way He can visit you. This is why Paul said, "I do not want to become as one that beateth the air." You can have all the energy in the world for God and be sold out as the day is long, but sold out to the wrong thing. You become one who beats the air.

How would God visit you? The same way He visits anybody else. He would send people to preach to you, talk to you, work signs and wonders in front of you. He would send laborers across your path. He would do everything He could. But to put on some great private show for you because you are special, He cannot do that. We all come out of the same gate.

You are born again. He has no respect of persons. You have the same access to God as the apostle Paul. Not the same call, but the same access. He has no respect of persons. He cannot play favorites.

Even though someone may sell out in much of their ministry, they may still be beating the air. I admire anybody who would do good work out of what measure of God they had. But if much of their life is beating the air, then that must be said.

I do not talk like this generally in other services, but then again, you do not come to the early class to sit in other services. If you did not want me to talk like that, you would not be here. I am not running anybody down. I am teaching what He has given me and unveiling deception on every level.

We are going to make it, but we have to know our enemy. That does not mean fellowship with him. I know him pretty well now. It was harder to survive him in the early days. Now he is a source of amusement.

James said count it all joy, did he not? If you only count it joy when you are not in a trial, then you do not have much joy. You had better start counting it joy so you can have some.

To become one who beats the air is to have all the zeal, energy, and love for your concept of God, to sell out to an idea and beat the air and beat the air.

How will God come and visit you? Do you want Him to fly over on a big cross with rockets shooting out like the Fourth of July, and your name written in firecrackers across the sky? You are in deception.

Or will someone like T. L. Osborn go to India, preach the gospel, and see hundreds of thousands healed right in front of you while you go on counting beads? How do you think He will come?

Someone says, "That is not true. Look at the way He came to the apostle Paul on the road to Damascus."

Yes, and Paul had heard the gospel. Here was someone who loved God with all the devil in him. From tradition and history, I understand that in that time a Pharisee, especially one studying for ministry, would memorize the Word of God from the age of three, six or seven hours a day. It is controversial whether Paul was married or not. He probably was not, but he may have been. He served on the Sanhedrin, and many believed you had to be married to do that.

Whether he was or not, one thing is sure: he loved God and served the idea of God through the law that he believed was correct in that day. He defended it even to putting Christians to death, whole families.

He consented to Stephen's death, even holding the coats of the men who stoned him. Stephen's last prayer was, "Lord, lay not this sin to their charge." Stephen, being a young man himself, made intercession for Paul and gave his whole life in that intercession.

When I asked God what Stephen got out of it, He said Stephen got Paul's reward.

Stephen gave his whole life in intercession, and Paul happened to get in the wrong meeting. Stephen made intercession for him. That gave God what He needed to drop down on Paul and have a talk with him.

"Saul, Saul, why are you kicking against the pricks?"

"Who are You?"

"I am Jesus whom you persecute."

And it was over.

Paul said God did not waste Himself upon him. At the end of his life, he said:

I laboured more abundantly than they all.

In favor of your lost loved ones, you touch heaven with your authority. When calling in the lost, hold their names up before God, and hold up the names of all the lost in this city.

Maybe we ought to get a phone book and put it in that box. Then people can argue all they want about calling those things that be not. "Can you call your lost loved ones?" "Yes, but you cannot call the city."

What is a city? Would it be a city if there were not people in it? All right, we will make it official. We will get a phone book. Now we have their names. Is it legal now?

You touch God with your authority. I will tell you what will happen. First, He will start sending laborers. He will send angels they cannot detect, atmosphere angels. Before you finish your prayer, those angels will find that person you are praying for, whether prodigal or one who has never known anything. The angels will start creating an atmosphere conducive for salvation.

Then laborers will come, because laborers cannot beat the angels there; angels are faster. A continual stream of laborers will come across their path, usually people they can identify with.

If your son is a motorcycle rider with chains hanging off him, God may get somebody from Copeland's to go after him. If your son is a doctor, do you think God cannot find a saved, turned-on doctor to move into the office next to your doctor friend? Pretty soon he is hearing about miracles taking place in the hospital. Your doctor son can remember when.

If that does not work over a certain amount of years, then pretty soon angels will start appearing to him. That will scare a few weeks out of you.

I know a man who tormented his wife terribly, and she was a minister. She traveled and preached, and he made her life hard. One day he woke up, opened his eyes, and a big angel was standing at the foot of his bed, just looking at him. In that one look, every excuse he ever had for doing what he was doing was gone. The angel did not even say anything.

If angel visitations do not work, you do not give up. The Head of the Church does not give up. Can you believe, like Saul, that the Head of the Church will pay your prodigal or lost loved one a visit if you will not give up? He did it for one.

How many would rather not be calling the lost in every night, every week? How many would rather the church not take an official position on that? I did not think so.

How many think maybe we pray too much?

How many will take an official position that maybe we do not have enough programs yet, but when we do, they will be Spirit-born programs?

Amen.

How many will say that if we continue like we are going, before the mission of the prayer center is done, it will have drastically affected Tulsa?

Hallelujah. Glory be to God.

I can believe that much more easily now than I could three years ago.

"Why is it taking so long?"

How many cities get born again? There must be a whole lot in there that is hardly ever received or learned. If cities hardly ever get saved, then obviously people are not going where cities are saved in the Spirit. If somebody in town knew how to get the city saved, it probably would already be saved. Since it has not, that means we are going to have to go somewhere we have never been before.

In order to go there, we have to find out how. That is where we are now.

Hallelujah.

Because God unveiled Himself to me, I think I am becoming a friend. I think I am moving toward friend status. I am hearing a lot concerning His Word, but in that last fast and seeking time, I heard many things I had never heard before. I wept like I had never wept before. I was touched in my heart like never before.

Once you get a little addicted to that, I can hardly stand it. It has changed my whole life.

Gary gets up, smirks, and says, "We are enjoying watching our pastor change."

I think, "How bad was I?" But I know it was not bad to good; it was good to better.

You cannot touch Him, and have Him touch your heart, without it changing you. I have been crying for three or four months now. This anointing will come to a certain point, and I cannot hold it. I have almost quit trying. I just try to hold the line.

When He put the worship limb on about two years ago, I think it was necessary to bring me to this next step. I am laying this foundation because of where we are going.

To enter into the kind of fellowship I needed to enter into, at a certain point of praying in tongues, the mystery of worship dropped into my spirit. On the born-again trail, it was necessary for that limb to be connected for me to go further down the trail, experience God, and come to know Him.

Praying in tongues is a revelation gift. It reveals the understandings and mysteries, not only of His Word, but of the operations of the Spirit, the giftings, the power, the glory, and all those things men cannot give you.

I am convinced that where He is bringing us now, particularly me, though I hope I am not just running out ahead of you, He wants you to take a bath in this one day. I do not know why He would give me something in the area of love and visit me like that if He would not visit you with it.

On this trail, He put the worship limb on. The mystery of worship dropped into me from praying in tongues. My foundation got to the place where He put the walls on, and finally He said, "Now, for you to go on into Me, you are going to have to find out more about worship."

Because I prayed myself to that place in tongues, and He slew me out in the power here, He said, "You do not know anything about worship." He went on and on until He put enough in me that I was willing to lock myself up hours a day, day after day, to find out what I did not know.

One amazing thing I found out is that God would come in waves, and then retreat back to the other side of the flesh I walked in. I would worship and worship until it became dry. But I would not stop because His instruction was to go in. He even told me how many hours a day to worship.

Just because I got as dry as a cracker-juice sandwich did not mean I could stop. I said, "I love You," dry as could be, but I would not stop.

Now I understand that He retreated to the other side of the flesh and let me worship. Once in a while He would come over and visit me. That layer of flesh got thinner and thinner, until one day He just came and pretty much stayed.

I lift my hands, and there He is.

Boy, am I enjoying that anointing of the believer. I am enjoying it.

Is this the gifting that goes with your calling, evangelist or another office? No. This one is an anointing that comes and does things.

In fact, Friday night when I lifted my hands and He came, it seemed like a mixture of presence and the gift of faith. It just stayed on me. I went back to the office trying to pull myself together and turned the prayer line over to Donna.

After I recovered a little, I stepped back into the auditorium, and people were all over the floor laughing. Rochelle will have to give you the testimony of what happened when that anointing came.

I was in the office, basking in His presence and enjoying myself immensely. That anointing was just inches away. It seems like it is that way all the time.

When I was in Cleveland, Brad was having an attack with his heart. He called me on the phone, and God healed him over the phone because the glory filled the car. He almost ran off the road. He sat there and got completely healed of his heart attack, then went home and slept twelve hours and caught up on what he had been doing wrong, probably not sleeping and resting enough.

I did not learn the full story until I got here. While we were talking about that testimony, Denise called. They had just discovered a growth in his wife, a growth the size of a thumb. I said, "Put your finger on it," and the glory hit. Brad fell against the car, and I could not even pray over the phone anymore. Denise started crying and shouting and laughing on the other end because the growth disappeared under her thumb.

I love that anointing of the believer.

Then I was sitting back there, and Rochelle stepped through the door. I said, "Come in." One of her eyes was almost closed because the pain was so bad. She was in excruciating pain and had a temperature so hot she was red. You could feel the heat coming off of her.

I love it when He does that. I just lifted my hands, and there He was, instantly. I reached up to touch her, but did not get much of a chance. Down she went. He was all over her. In about five seconds, she turned a normal color. Every bit of the temperature left, and she got up with no pain.

We are talking about a veteran of the prayer center for five years. That is a veteran.

She had been suffering from a migraine. He is liable to have healed her for good.

John G. Lake trained and launched fourteen hundred ministers in five to seven years and started seven hundred churches. He was probably a David Hogan of the bush in Africa.

He said you have to touch God with your spirit because faith is only a product of the spirit. Faith is not a product of this head. If you do not fellowship with God on a personal level, fellowship with Him around His Word, and get to know Him, then even if you have memorized the whole Word of God, you may not have an ounce of faith.

When you fellowship and get to know Him, because that is what His Word points you to, faith is produced in your spirit. Lake said the reason many people's faith is weak is that their spirit is drying up from lack of fellowship.

Once you touch Him, that is where that anointing comes from.

One of John G. Lake's favorite things was to have doctors hook him up to a machine so they could measure response. He would say, "Leave enough room to get my hand in there." He would put his hand in, the life of God would flow, and they could watch the healing take place on the machine. Many doctors were saved like that.

This is not the anointing that goes with an office. I used to enjoy God. I would come in, we would worship, I would pray and wait, and pretty soon the anointing that came when I taught and preached would come. Then suddenly it would change, and the anointing for signs and wonders

would be with me. I would go out into the crowd.

But when the service was over, that would lift off me and the crowd. I could tell when it left. Usually it would not be on me again until the next service I did somewhere.

The anointing of the believer is communion with God out of your spirit:

These signs shall follow them that believe.

They will lay hands on the sick and the sick will recover. They will speak with new tongues, pray in those tongues, and cast out devils.

We are not talking about an anointing God has mercy and puts on your calling because if He did not, He would not have anybody. We are talking about the anointing of the believer on the born-again trail. He wanted me to teach you about this limb so that through worship and praying in tongues, you can touch Him where He will come and stay too.

"I have a job."

So did every other saint in history who touched Him.

"I do not have time."

Neither did any saint in history who ever touched Him.

No buts.

Friday night we were having such a time with waves of glory and worship, and the gift of faith pegged us. Anybody who was here knows there was no use trying natural order. Everybody was too spontaneous. You did not know whether you were going to sit or stand, so you were doing both.

Up, down, up, down. I was not telling you to do it. You were doing it.

Then Sally came up and sang, "Thy Word is a lamp unto my feet." We brought prayer requests up and piled them in the box and over in the corner. Waves of faith were rolling over those requests. God told me, "You do not just pray. You receive answers."

So He said to me, "Have all of them who wrote their prayer requests down, when I answer them in the next three months, write the answer down and bring it up and lay it on that step again."

Sally sang, "Thy Word is a lamp unto my feet." God's Word is a light unto my pathway. His Word is a lamp unto my feet.

Sally should have been dead two or three years ago. Her body was eating itself, consuming itself. She should have been gone home, but she came down here and we took up the fight. We know how to fight.

You do not know the pain she was in at times. Her jaw would lock up where she could not open it all the way, but never did she fail to sing a single song I asked her to sing. One song was so hard to hit the note that you really had to open your mouth. She made it through, while it was fighting her.

She was standing up there after finishing that song, and the anointing was still on. That was just before Rochelle was healed. I could not help it. I ran up and grabbed Sally by the jaw. It started popping while she was laying on the floor. As soon as I touched her face, her jaw cracked right into place. The rest of it kept cracking while she worshiped.

Hallelujah.

I could not stand it anymore, so I went back. I do not know if I ended up weeping on the floor or what, but I am reading the signs better now of when I should leave.

I thank God for the ministries developing, like my sister who steps in, or Gary, or some of you others. I got the biggest kick out of it when I recovered a little and came to the door, and people were just laughing like crazy. My brother, I understand, was trying to help Donna but fell against the wall and slid down. Big help he is.

It does not matter how big and strong you are when you slide down the wall.

Amen.

Do you really believe this is available for every child of God?

Oh yes. Jesus paid the price for sickness, disease, and demon possession, and you are the believer. I believe it. I believe you can cause all kinds of trouble wherever you go for the devil, sickness, and disease. The quicker you get yourself off your hands, the quicker that is going to happen.

How can you tell you are getting yourself off your hands? When you get that steel in your backbone, that endurance to steal those hours at your own cost, and start worshiping Him and seeking Him until He is able to do those things in you.

Hallelujah.

It is all yours. It is yours. You are victory. You are an anointing somewhere ready to take place.

But why in the world would God need to give that to you unless you are going to place yourself between people, God, and the need? Why give you the gift of healing when you never cross the street to get someone healed?

He that has ears, let him hear what the Spirit is saying.

Are you a holiness church? Oh yes, we believe in adorning the inner man with holiness. We do not care if your knees are showing. You adorn yourself in the inner man. Any modesty will be received in due course.

Let us look at where we were supposed to have gone. It is forming in my spirit, and as you know, it will be said before it is over, probably several times.

Matthew 16:20 says:

Then charged He His disciples that they should tell no man that He was Jesus the Christ.

From that time forth began Jesus to shew unto His disciples, how that He must go unto Jerusalem, and suffer many things of the elders and chief priests and scribes, and be killed, and be raised again the third day.

Then Peter took Him, and began to rebuke Him, saying, Be it far from Thee, Lord: this shall not be unto Thee.

But He turned, and said unto Peter, Get thee behind Me, Satan: thou art an offence unto Me: for thou savourest not the things that be of God, but those that be of men.

Is that not interesting? He is addressing Peter, but He is talking to Satan.

He said, "You are an offense to Me, for you do not savor the things of God, but the things of men." A savory smell or taste is like preparing the seasonings for Thanksgiving turkey. It takes longer than you thought, so you are a little past hungry, and your senses are heightened. You smell that turkey and dressing.

I remember fasting on Thanksgiving when I thought sacrificing turkeys was pleasing to God. I went down to the little store to get seasonings, and people were cooking turkeys in this little town in Oregon. They had their windows open, and I could smell those turkeys every time I went by a house because my senses were heightened. What a savory smell.

God used that word when an animal's burning flesh allowed Him to operate with an unredeemed race. It was a sweet smell to Him to be able to operate with His people.

But Jesus said to Satan, "You savor the things of men." Meaning, just like you would season a meal slowly to make it just right, that is how Satan wants to take you apart. He wants to make sure everything is just right. He wants to inhale you and take all the time he needs, because he loves your destruction. By the time he has you for a meal, he wants to pick your bones.

So much for that doctrine that if the princes of this world had known He was the Lord of glory, they would not have crucified Him. In faith teaching we said, "It was hidden, so the devil did not know who Jesus was. He was stabbing in the dark and excited the crowd to kill Him."

That seems contradictory, does it not? Here Jesus was not talking to Peter. Satan was using Peter, saying, "No, You are not going to die." Jesus turned around and said, "Get behind Me, Satan." Why was Satan trying to stop Him if he did not know the cross would be his undoing?

Who are those princes that the Church will make known the manifold wisdom of God to? Powers and principalities. What caste will the Church make known His glory and power to? It is the kingdoms of this world, but we will have to get into that later.

The only reason I brought this up is that many times when God addressed a man, He was addressing Satan. Sometimes He addressed the man and Satan at the same time. He was saying, "Satan, I know where you are, and I know what you are doing."

That is what He did here. Peter made that statement, and Jesus said, "Get behind Me, Satan." In other words, "I know you are hiding and using this man, devil."

This is what He did in both Ezekiel and Isaiah when He addressed the king of Tyre and the king of Babylon. He said, "Prophecy to the king of Tyre," and ended up describing Satan and his fall. Many times, instead of naming Satan, He named the man Satan was working behind or hiding behind. God was saying, "Prophecy to this man because, Satan, I know you are standing behind him to destroy, and I am exposing you by exposing him."

When I discovered this, I was able to go behind the scenes and see what God had said about Satan. That is when I started finding out who Satan really was as the anointed cherub that covered, and what worship means to God.

Anyway, we will have to stop right there. Jesus unmasked Satan by talking to a man, and that was common under the Old Testament.

Hallelujah.